WEATHERING THE GLOBAL STORM

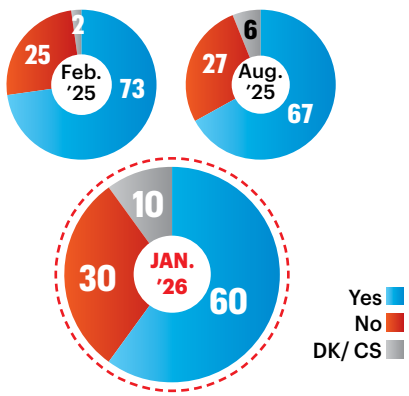
With Donald Trump upending the world order and weaponising tariffs, India is diversifying partnerships and pursuing reforms to align with its changed strategic needs—a trajectory that has the support of a majority of Indians

By **PRADIP R. SAGAR**

Early in January, S. Jaishankar, the external affairs minister, said at an event that India's influence in its neighbourhood is built on trust, cooperation and shared prosperity, not coercion. India supports good actions by neighbours and sets "red lines" for bad ones, he added. It is a good prism through which to view India's neighbourhood policy.

New Delhi has navigated a delicate post-Sheikh Hasina transition in Bangladesh through restraint and dialogue and strengthened ties with Sri Lanka, Nepal and the Maldives through economic measures. However, relations with Pakistan remain frozen in a security-dominant mode, while repairing relations with China, Islamabad's

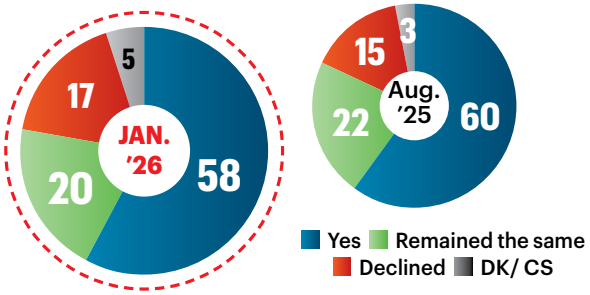
Q. Do you think Indian foreign policy under the NDA government has strengthened its global standing?*



Though marginally down, most respondents think foreign policy under NDA is robust

*This question was asked before the India-EU trade deal

Q. Do you think India's global influence and reputation have improved in recent years?



Over two-thirds say India's global influence has improved/ stayed the same

NEW VIBRATIONS PM Modi with Russian president Vladimir Putin and his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping at the SCO Summit, Sept. 1, 2025



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